TA studio brief — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

TA practical setup & focus

Pre-cut 6 cm x 6 cm greyboard swatch squares so every pupil can run a quick material test before modifying their main panel.

Studio kit: Week 2-3 relief panels, critique diagnostic cards, scrap greyboard swatch tiles, corrugated/smooth card, foil, dark wash, dry-brush chrome/chalk

Key words to prompt

• critique: A structured studio check that identifies strengths and specific next steps.

• diagnostic: Spotting the exact visual or structural reason why an area looks weak.

• redirect: Adjusting your plan or adding a layer to solve a design problem.

• swatch: A small test piece used to try a fix before putting it on your main artwork.

• focal joint: The main structural intersection where beams meet and draw the eye.

Supported route steps

1. Prop your panel up and tick one strength and one target on your critique card.

2. Test your chosen fix (adding a foil strip or chrome dry-brush) on a small scrap square.

3. Apply the same fix onto your main relief panel.

4. Glue your test swatch onto your log sheet and tick 'Fix applied'.

Check: Critique card ticked, test swatch mounted in log, and upgrade applied to main panel.

Review & exit support

Exit question: Why do we keep and mount our small test swatch in our studio log?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to structure a calm, two-minute 'Strength / Target / Swatch' peer critique in the studio.